Shreyas Meher

Postdoctoral Researcher, Erasmus University Rotterdam
meher@essb.eur.nl | shreyasmeher.com | github.com/shreyasmeher | (+1) 972-571-8290

Employment

Erasmus University Rotterdam June 2025 – present

Postdoctoral Researcher, Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences
TWIN4DEM project (Horizon Europe): digital twins of executive aggrandizement in parliamentary democracies

The University of Texas at Dallas August 2023 – May 2025

Graduate Research Assistant, NSF project *Frameworks: Infrastructure for Political and Social Event Data Using Machine Learning*

The University of Texas at Dallas August 2020 – July 2023

Teaching Assistant, School of Economic, Political and Policy Sciences

Education

Ph.D., Public Policy and Political Economy 2025

The University of Texas at Dallas
Dissertation: *Digital Sovereignty: The Political Economy of Internet Governance*
Committee: Clint Peinhardt (Chair), Pengfei Zhang (Co-Chair), Patrick T. Brandt

M.S., Management 2020

The University of Texas at Dallas

M.S., Public Policy 2018

St. Xavier's College, Mumbai

B.S., Economics 2016

Sarla Anil Modi School of Economics, NMIMS, Mumbai

Research Interests

Digital governance and internet censorship, democratic backsliding and executive aggrandizement, political conflict, computational social science and large language models

Publications

Brandt, P. T., Alsarra, S., D'Orazio, V., Heintze, D., Khan, L., **Meher, S.**, Osorio, J., & Sianan, M. (2025). Extractive versus generative language models for political conflict text classification. *Political Analysis*, 1–29. doi:10.1017/pan.2025.10027

Meher, S., & Brandt, P. T. (2025). ConflLlama: Domain-specific adaptation of large language models for conflict event classification. *Research & Politics*, *12*(3). doi:10.1177/20531680251356282

Kumar, S., **Meher, S.**, & Zhang, P. (2025). Public health advocacy in times of pandemic: An analysis of the Medicare-For-All debate on Twitter during COVID-19. *Behavioral Sciences*, *15*(2),

223. doi:10.3390/bs15020223

Egger, C., **Meher, S.**, & Zhelyazkova, A. (forthcoming). Framework laws and fading oversight: How the Dutch executive expanded its lawmaking authority. *International Political Science Review*.

Meher, S. (forthcoming). Preferential delegation: How rulemaking authority concentrates in the Dutch law-to-regulation network. In *Proceedings of the 15th International Conference on Complex Networks and Their Applications (COMPLEX NETWORKS 2026)*, Studies in Computational Intelligence. Springer.

Zhang, P., & **Meher, S.** (forthcoming). The political returns to ICT investment: Information control of authoritarian regimes. In *Proceedings of the International Congress on Information and Communication Technology (ICICT 2027)*, Lecture Notes in Networks and Systems. Springer.

Under Review

Silencing the Silencing: The Uneven Amplification of Internet Shutdowns in India's English-Language Press. *Political Communication*, *revise & resubmit*

Selective Scrutiny: Single-Party Majority and the Strategic Withdrawal of Parliamentary Oversight in India. *The Journal of Legislative Studies*, *revise & resubmit*

Electoral Accountability and the Channeling of Content Removal: Theory and Evidence from Google Transparency Reports (with Pengfei Zhang)

Two Types of Censorship? An Assessment of the Informational Autocracy Thesis (with Pengfei Zhang)

Build, Borrow, or Just Fine-Tune? Empirical Guidelines for NLP Model Selection in Computational Social Science

"Why Aren't We Talking About This?" The Attention Trap in Networked Protest

Using Messy Text in Future LLM Annotations (with Patrick T. Brandt, Paula Cuellar-Cuellar & Xingyuan Zhao)

Working Papers

Building Capacity or Building Checks? What EU Enlargement Reports Emphasise and Democratic Backsliding (with Asya Zhelyazkova & Clara Egger)

Strategic Anticipation and Expert Review: The Determinants of Critical Advisory Opinions from the Dutch Council of State (with Clara Egger & Asya Zhelyazkova)

On Time, but Empty: How Dutch Ministers Answer Their Critics

Grants & Funded Research

TWIN4DEM: Strengthening Democratic Resilience Through Digital Twins 2025 – 2027

Horizon Europe. Postdoctoral Researcher; PIs: Clara Egger & Asya Zhelyazkova

Frameworks: Infrastructure for Political and Social Event Data 2023 – 2026

National Science Foundation. Graduate Research Assistant; PI: Patrick T. Brandt

PESOSE: Developing an Open-Source Ecosystem for Computational Conflict Research Submitted 2026

National Science Foundation (PESOSE Track 1), pending. Unpaid key personnel; PI: Javier

Osorio, University of Arizona

Software

conflibertR (CRAN, 2026): R package bringing ConfliBERT to R: entity recognition, event classification, question answering, fine-tuning, model comparison, and active learning.

ConfliBERT GUI: Browser-based NLP toolkit for conflict and political violence text analysis: named entity recognition, classification, question answering, and LoRA/QLoRA fine-tuning.

NL Agent Explorer: Interactive explorer of agent-level data on Dutch national politics, 2008 to 2025 (members, ministers, offices, committees, bills, Council of State advice, and a yearly stance on executive power estimated from plenary speech). Built for TWIN4DEM.

Fine-tuned language models (open weights at huggingface.co/shreyasmeher)

- **ConflLlama**: Llama 3 8B fine-tuned on the Global Terrorism Database for attack-type classification, with an alternative chat-template version and four time-period variants.
- **ConflLlama-NER**: Llama 3.1 8B Instruct fine-tuned to identify source, target, and related actors in conflict event narratives.
- **ConflLlama-NER-TOI**: Named entity recognition for Indian news, trained on 100,000 *Times of India* articles.
- **Qwen-GLOCON-Reasoning**: Qwen2.5-3B trained with GRPO reinforcement learning to classify conflict events with structured reasoning.
- **Confli-mBERT**: ModernBERT fine-tuned on the Global Terrorism Database for conflict event classification.

Teaching

Instructor, Global Development Issues 2025 – 2026

Erasmus University Rotterdam. Quantitative research design for policy evaluation, causal inference, and panel data estimation, with R programming labs.

Supervisor, MISOC Bachelor Project 2025 – 2026

Erasmus University Rotterdam. Digital governance, platform labour, and power in the digital economy.

Instructor, EPPS Math & Coding Camp August 2024

The University of Texas at Dallas. Five-day intensive for incoming Ph.D. students: R programming, data manipulation, visualization, and linear regression.

Teaching Assistant, The University of Texas at Dallas 2020 – 2023

Research Design (EPPS 2301); Class, Status, and Power (SOC 4302); Political Economy of Industrialized Countries (IPEC 4301); Government and Politics of Afghanistan (PSCI 4396); Applied Regression (EPPS 6316); Political Violence and Conflict in Cyberspace (PPPE/PSCI 6302); Introduction to Quantitative Methods (EPPS 6313); Foreign Aid and Development (IPEC/PSCI 4318)

Conference Presentations

International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC^2S^2)	2025
American Political Science Association (APSA)	2024, 2025
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2024, 2025, 2026
European Political Science Society (EPSS)	2026
International Studies Association (ISA)	2025
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)	2024
Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics (SIOE)	2024
UTD PPPE Working Paper Series	2023

Honors & Awards

CAFÉ Research Scholar 2020

The Colloquium for the Advancement of Free-Enterprise Education, UT Dallas

Dean's Excellence Scholarship 2020

The University of Texas at Dallas

Service & Other

Peer reviewer: *Political Behavior*

Book contribution: *American Government* & *State and Local Government*, Cognella Publishing (2021)

Skills

R, Python, Stata, LaTeX, ArcGIS, C++

Languages

English, Hindi, Marathi

References

Patrick T. Brandt
Professor of Public Policy, Political Economy, and Political Science
The University of Texas at Dallas
pbrandt@utdallas.edu

Clint Peinhardt
Professor of Political Science, Public Policy and Political Economy
The University of Texas at Dallas
clint.peinhardt@utdallas.edu

Pengfei Zhang
Assistant Professor of Public Policy and Political Economy
The University of Texas at Dallas
pengfei.zhang@utdallas.edu

Karl Ho
Professor of Instruction
The University of Texas at Dallas
kyho@utdallas.edu